

Travelling to US? Get vaccinated to be safe

Getting vaccinated against diseases unheard of at home **was** something people in 'first world' countries did before travelling to **faraway** places, especially the tropics. The **ability** to **eradicate** illnesses like rubella, measles and polio **was** long considered a **marker** of development. But, **of late**, **rich Indians** travelling to the US **are** being advised to ensure they're up to date on their vaccinations for 'childhood' diseases.

There's good reason to follow this **advisory**. **The number** of reported measles cases in the US **has** hit a 33-year high, with over 1,300 confirmed infections as of July. **The data**, released by Johns Hopkins University, **marks a milestone** in the **ongoing outbreak** of a highly **contagious**, vaccine-preventable disease once declared **eliminated** in the US. 92% cases were people who were either **unvaccinated** or whose vaccination status was unknown, according to CDC. **Resurgence** of these diseases is due to a drop in vaccination rates in the US. While the decline began before the pandemic, Covid **disruptions** to healthcare acted as a **booster shot** for resurgence. Many parents chose not to vaccinate their children because they 'didn't see these diseases', while vaccine **fatigue**, **misinformation** and growing **distrust played their part**. US secretary of health Robert F Kennedy Jr previously spread misinformation about childhood vaccinations and **downplayed** the outbreak - before **eventually endorsing** MMR (measles, mumps, rubella) vaccine as infections **surged**.



Ironically, while the US requires all **immigrants** to be vaccinated against a range of diseases to protect its residents, it cannot **impose** the same on its own citizens. So, if you're **heading** to the US, you'll require more than your visa. Take your shots, and enter the US at your own health risk.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

[\[Practice Exercise\]](#)

Vocabulary

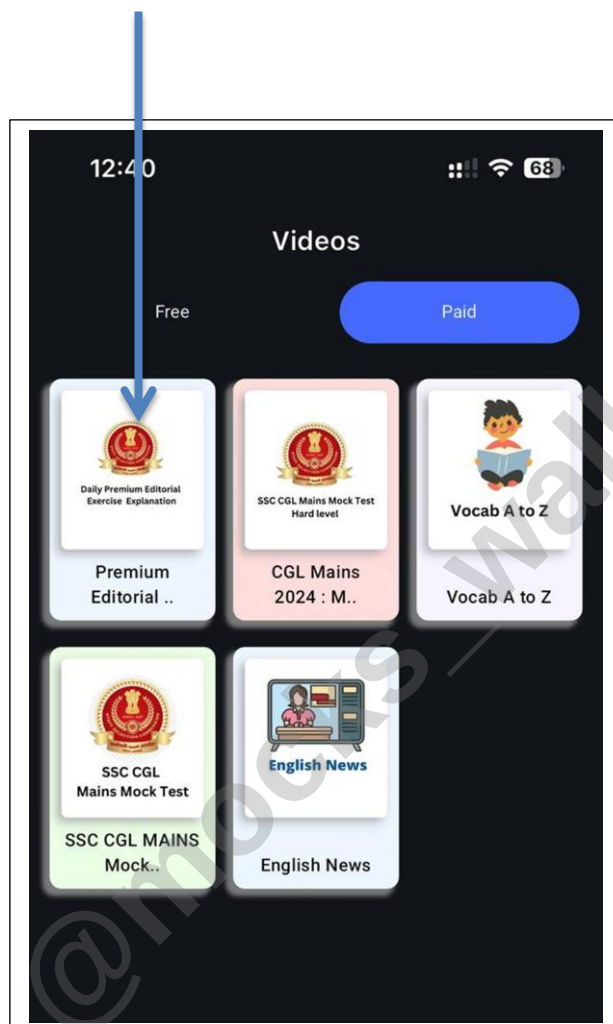
1. **Vaccinate** (verb) – immunize, inoculate, inject, protect, safeguard टीका लगाना
2. **Faraway** (adjective) – distant, remote, far-flung, outlying, secluded दूर
3. **Eradicate** (verb) – eliminate, abolish, wipe out, uproot, extinguish समाप्त करना
4. **Marker** (noun) – indicator, sign, symbol, signal, measure संकेतक
5. **Of late** (phrase) – recently, lately, in recent times, as of now, nowadays हाल ही में
6. **Advisory** (noun) – recommendation, guideline, notice, suggestion, bulletin परामर्श
7. **Mark a milestone** (phrase) – signify progress, indicate achievement, denote landmark, represent stage, highlight breakthrough मील का पत्थर चिन्हित करना
8. **Ongoing** (adjective) – continuing, current, prevailing, persistent, continuous जारी
9. **Outbreak** (noun) – eruption, surge, epidemic, flare-up, burst प्रकोप
10. **Contagious** (adjective) – infectious, communicable, transmittable, catching, spreading संक्रामक
11. **Eliminate** (verb) – remove, eradicate, abolish, get rid of, exterminate समाप्त करना
12. **Unvaccinated** (adjective) – unprotected, non-immunized, exposed, at risk, susceptible बिना टीका लगाया हुआ
13. **Resurgence** (noun) – revival, rebound, comeback, reappearance, renewal पुनरुत्थान
14. **Disruption** (noun) – interruption, breakdown, disturbance, interference, hindrance बाधा
15. **Booster shot** (noun) – an injection of a small amount of a substance, especially a vaccine, that is given to increase the effect of the same substance that was given some time before.
16. **Fatigue** (noun) – tiredness, exhaustion, weariness, burnout, languor थकावट
17. **Misinformation** (noun) – false information, disinformation, lies, untruths, deception गलत सूचना
18. **Distrust** (noun) – suspicion, doubt, skepticism, disbelief, wariness अविश्वास

19. **Play one's part** (phrase) – contribute, take part, participate, assist, be involved
भूमिका निभाना
20. **Downplay** (verb) – minimize, understate, belittle, dismiss, de-emphasize कम महत्व देना
21. **Eventually** (adverb) – finally, ultimately, in the end, at last, sooner or later अंततः
22. **Endorse** (verb) – support, approve, advocate, back, recommend समर्थन करना
23. **Surge** (noun) – rise, increase, escalation, upswing, spike वृद्धि
24. **Ironically** (adverb) – paradoxically, surprisingly, contradictorily, peculiarly, oddly विडंबनापूर्ण ढंग से
25. **Immigrant** (noun) – newcomer, settler, expatriate, alien, foreigner प्रवासी
26. **Impose** (verb) – enforce, mandate, dictate, implement, compel थोपना
27. **Head (to)** (verb) – go, move, travel, proceed, make one's way जाना

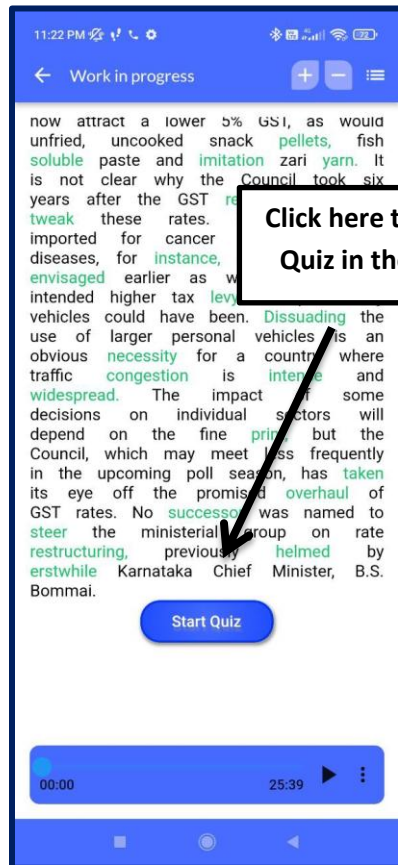
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Changing Norms:** Traditionally, vaccinations were recommended for people from wealthy countries visiting tropical regions; now, the reverse is true.
2. **India to US Advisory:** Indians traveling to the U.S. are now being advised to ensure they are vaccinated against childhood diseases.
3. **Measles Outbreak:** The U.S. has seen a sharp rise in measles cases, hitting a 33-year high with over 1,300 confirmed infections.
4. **Johns Hopkins Data:** This data, released by Johns Hopkins University, highlights the severity of the outbreak.
5. **Preventable Disease:** Measles is highly contagious but preventable through vaccination and was once considered eliminated in the U.S.
6. **Unvaccinated Majority:** 92% of cases occurred in individuals who were unvaccinated or whose vaccination status was unknown.
7. **Vaccination Decline:** The resurgence is largely due to declining vaccination rates, which began before the COVID-19 pandemic.
8. **Pandemic Impact:** The pandemic disrupted healthcare systems, worsening the decline in routine childhood vaccinations.
9. **Misinformation Factor:** Vaccine fatigue, disinformation, and public distrust have contributed to lower immunization rates.
10. **Political Influence:** U.S. health figure Robert F. Kennedy Jr. initially spread anti-vaccine views and downplayed the outbreak.
11. **Reversal of Stance:** Under growing pressure, Kennedy eventually endorsed the MMR vaccine as measles cases spiked.
12. **Policy Irony:** The U.S. mandates vaccines for immigrants but cannot legally enforce the same requirement for its citizens.
13. **Health Risk to Visitors:** Travelers to the U.S. now face health risks due to low community immunization.
14. **Practical Advice:** Indian travelers must ensure they are fully vaccinated before visiting the U.S. to avoid infection.
15. **Larger Message:** The situation reflects a global irony where a developed nation is facing outbreaks of diseases once thought eradicated, due to complacency and misinformation.

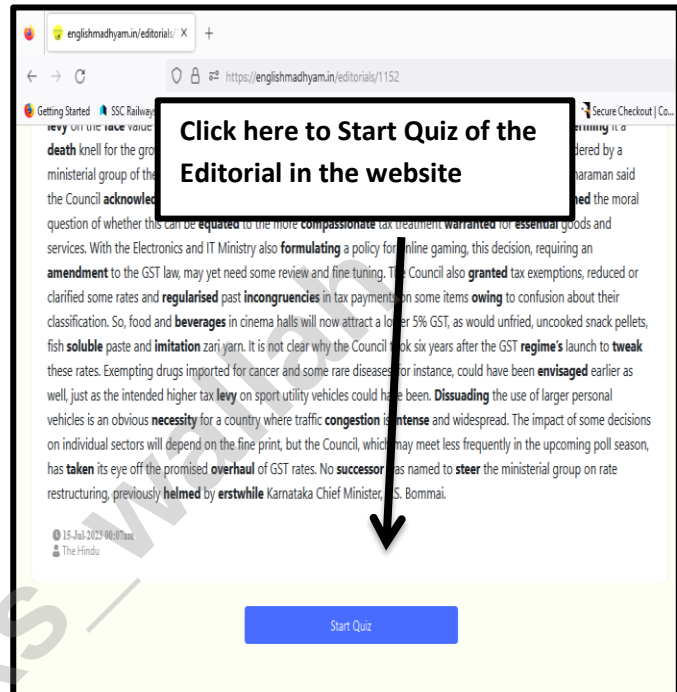
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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